

Camel Up — Quick Teach

3-8 players · ~30 min · Most money wins

A betting game disguised as a camel race. Camels move randomly via a pyramid die-roller, but they ride on each other's backs — a stack moves together, so the camel on top is "winning" even if it didn't roll. Bet on legs, bet on the overall race, and try to read the chaos.

Goal

Most Egyptian Pounds (EP) when any camel crosses the finish line.

Components

- Game board (track + 3D pyramid + palm tree)
- 5 racing camels (blue/yellow/green/red/purple) + 5 matching dice (faces 1-2-3, each twice)
- 2 crazy camels (white/black) + 1 grey die (white 1-2-3 / black 1-2-3)
- 20 betting tickets (4 per color: values **5, 3, 2, 2**)
- 5 pyramid tickets · 80 EP coins (50×1, 30×5)
- 40 finish cards (5 per character) · 8 spectator tiles · 8 partnership cards (6+ players only)
- 1 starting player marker · 1 dice pyramid

Setup

1. Place board (16-space oval track + finish line after space 16).
 2. Stack each color's betting tickets: **5 on top, 3 below, then 2, 2** at the bottom; place each stack on its tent.
 3. Pyramid tickets stacked on board. EP coins = bank.
 4. Each player: **3 EP**, 5 finish cards (one character), 1 spectator tile. (6+: also 1 partnership card "available" side up.)
 5. **Roll all 5 racing dice** to set starting positions: die showing 1 → space 1, 2 → space 2, 3 → space 3. Same space = stack (any order). All face clockwise.
 6. **Crazy camels:** roll grey die. **1 → space 16, 2 → 15, 3 → 14**. Place one crazy camel; roll grey die again for the other (same space → stacked on first). Both face counterclockwise.
 7. Drop all 6 dice (5 racing + grey) into pyramid; cap it; place pyramid on board.
 8. Youngest player gets the start marker.
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Camel Movement Rules

- Camels on the same space form a **stack**. When a stacked camel moves, it carries every camel **on top of it**; ones beneath are left.
 - The moving stack-portion is a **camel unit**.
 - Landing on another unit → unit lands **on top** of it (boogie tile lands **underneath** instead).
 - **Ranking:** farther along the track (clockwise) = ahead; on the same space, higher in the stack = ahead. Crazy camels are **ignored for ranking**.
 - Racing camels run **clockwise**; crazy camels run **counterclockwise**. Orientation never changes (even when moving backward).
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On Your Turn — Choose 1 Action

1. Take a Betting Ticket

Take the top ticket of any color. You're backing that camel for this leg. No limit on how many tickets you collect (even multiple of the same color).

2. Place / Move Spectator Tile

Place on an **empty** track space (no camels, no other spectator tile), **not space 1**, **not adjacent** to another spectator tile. Pick a side:

- **Cheering** → camel landing here moves **+1 forward** (lands on top of any unit).
- **Booing** → camel moves **-1 backward** (lands **underneath** any unit).
- **Crazy camels** trigger the same effect but in the opposite direction (cheering → +1 counterclockwise; booing → -1, i.e. clockwise).
- You earn **1 EP** every time a camel lands on your tile. Tile stays put after triggering. May move it on a later turn.

3. Take Pyramid Ticket (Roll Pyramid)

Take the top pyramid ticket (worth +1 EP at leg scoring), shake the pyramid, reveal 1 die.

- **Racing die** → move that camel 1/2/3 spaces clockwise.
- **Grey die** → move the indicated **crazy camel** (white/black) the rolled number, **counterclockwise**. Two exceptions:
 - If only **one** crazy camel is currently carrying any racing camels, move that one regardless of color.
 - If one crazy camel is **directly stacked on the other** (no racing camels between), move the one **on top**.

After the move, place the revealed die into a free dice tent (so everyone tracks which dice are out).

4. Bet on Overall Winner OR Loser

Place 1 finish card **face down** on the overall winner space *or* overall loser space. Stacks on top of cards already there. Once placed, can't be retrieved.

5. Enter Betting Partnership (6+ players only)

Only if your partnership card is "available" side up. Choose another available player; swap cards (they can't refuse), each placed "partnership" side up. For the rest of the leg you're partners — at leg scoring, each partner may pick **1 of the other's tickets** (betting or pyramid) and add **its reward** to their own total (optional — e.g. skip if all of partner's tickets are negative). Both partners get this copy independently. After the leg, cards go back to original owners "available" side up.

End of a Leg

Triggered when the **5th (last) pyramid ticket** is taken — the active player still reveals a die and moves the camel, then **leg scoring** happens before the next player's turn. (One die always remains in the pyramid.)

Pay/collect (per ticket):

- Each ticket of the **leading** racing camel → printed value (**5/3/2/2**).
- Each ticket of **2nd-place** racing camel → **+1 EP**.
- Each ticket of any **3rd-5th** racing camel → **-1 EP**.
- Each pyramid ticket → **+1 EP**.

(Crazy camels are ignored for ranking. Leading camel = top of the stack on the highest-advanced space — stack position naturally breaks any "tie".)

Leg-end sequence: ① pass start marker to player **left of whoever took the last pyramid ticket** → ② score (above) → ③ cleanup: return betting tickets to tents (order **5 on top, 3, 2, 2** at bottom), pyramid tickets back in a stack, spectator tiles to owners, revealed dice back into pyramid.

End of the Game

Triggered the **moment any camel unit crosses the finish line** (even a crazy camel crossing counterclockwise — yes, this ends the game).

1. Do one final leg scoring.
2. **Overall Winner scoring:** flip the overall winner deck so first card placed is on top. For cards showing the actual winner: 1st card = **+8 EP**, 2nd = +5, 3rd = +3, 4th = +2, all later = +1. Cards showing wrong camel: **-1 EP** to bank.
3. **Overall Loser scoring:** same, but for the actual last-place racing camel (if last place is a stack, the loser is the camel on the **bottom** of that stack).
4. Most EP wins. Tie → shared victory.

Edge case: if a crazy camel carries racing camels across the finish line counterclockwise, those carried camels count as the **least advanced** for overall loser scoring.

Money Notes

- Stored publicly (stack however you want); no obligation to disclose totals.
- Exchange 1s↔5s with the bank any time.
- Can't go below 0 EP — if you can't afford a -1, you simply don't pay.